MING-YEN HO

Haas School of Business, University of California, Berkeley · 2220 Piedmont Avenue, Berkeley, CA 94720
mho@berkeley.edu · homervyn.github.io

RESEARCH AND TEACHING FIELDS

Primary Political Economy, Industrial Organization
Secondary Economics of Innovation, Development Economics, International Trade

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Business Administration (Business & Public Policy), UC Berkeley 2027 (expected)
Thesis: Essays on the Political Economy of High-tech Manufacturing
Committee: Matilde Bombardini, Francesco Trebbi, Matthew Backus
Designated Emphasis in Political Economy

M.A. in Analytical Political Economy, Duke University 2021

B.Soc.Sc. & LL.B., University of Hong Kong (First Class Honours) 2019

WORKING PAPERS

Picking Winners or Building Them? Central and Local Government Venture Capital in Chinese Semiconductors (Job Market Paper)
Presented at: Taiwan Economics Research Workshop, Academia Sinica (2025, 2026); New Thinking in Industrial Policy Conference, Columbia University (November 2026, scheduled)

Industrial Policy and Political Investment: Evidence from the CHIPS Act and Green Energy Transition, with Kevin Tse-luen Wu
Presented at: Japanese Society for Quantitative Political Science (JSQPS) Summer Meeting, Hitotsubashi University (July 2026); American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Boston (September 2026)

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Engineering Reality of Semiconductor Manufacturing Costs: Vintages, Learning, and Scale Economies, with Mitsuru Igami and Shao-yu Jheng

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Francesco Trebbi, UC Berkeley Feb 2023–May 2025

Research Assistant to Matthew Backus, UC Berkeley Jul 2022–2023

Research Assistant to Patrick Bayer and Marjorie McElroy, Duke University, and to Shitong Qiao, University of Hong Kong 2020–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Instructor, UC Berkeley
Undergraduate Macroeconomics Fall 2025, Spring 2026
PhD Economic Theory II Spring 2024, 2025
Intermediate Microeconomics Fall 2023, 2024
MBA Macroeconomics Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Duke University
MA Advanced Microeconomic Analysis Spring 2021
Intermediate Microeconomics I Summer 2020

POLICY AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Non-Resident Fellow, Research Institute for Democracy, Society, and Emerging Technology, National Science & Technology Council, Taiwan — Sep 2023–present

Intern, Government Affairs, TSMC North America, Washington, D.C. — May–Jun 2025

Intern, Productivity, Innovation & Entrepreneurship Division, OECD — Nov 2024–Apr 2025

Intern, Strategic Planning Intelligence Division, TSMC, Hsinchu, Taiwan — Summers 2022, 2024

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS AND AWARDS

Clausen Center Research Grant — 2025

Institute for Business Innovation Research Grant — 2025

UC IGCC Dissertation Fellowship — 2024–2025

Taiwan Ministry of Education Study Abroad Scholarship — 2024, 2025

BESI Political Economy Research Grant — 2023–2025

Fisher Center for Business Analytics Research Grant — 2023

Williamson PhD Research Fellowship — 2023

Duke Economics Masters' Scholar Award — 2019–2021

Hong Kong Trustees' Association Prize in Equity & Trusts — 2019

CALI Excellence for the Future Awards, Cornell Law School (top of the class in Law & Finance and Comparative Law: East Asian Legal Systems) — 2018

POLICY WRITING (NON-REFEREED)

"The Feasibility of a Hardwired Pause of Frontier AI Training." *Working Group on AI Pause Feasibility*, working paper (co-author) — Oct 2026

"Let a Hundred Flowers Bloom: Local Competition and the Rise of Chinese Semiconductor Capacity." *DSET Policy Report* — Jul 2025

"Carrots and Sticks? Taiwan and Semiconductor Supply Chains Under Trump 2.0." *The Diplomat*, with Min-Yen Chiang — Jan 2025

OTHER INFORMATION

Languages English, Mandarin, Cantonese, Burmese (intermediate)

Programming Python, Julia, Stata, R, QGIS

Refereeing Econometrica

Citizenship Taiwan (U.S. permanent resident since July 2022)

REFERENCES

Professor Matilde Bombardini
Oliver E. and Dolores Williamson Chair in the Economics of Organization
Haas School of Business
UC Berkeley
mbombardini@berkeley.edu

Professor Matthew Backus
Associate Professor
Haas School of Business and
Department of Economics
UC Berkeley
backus@berkeley.edu

Professor Chris Miller
Professor of International History
The Fletcher School
Tufts University
christopher.miller@tufts.edu

Professor Francesco Trebbi
B. T. Rocca Jr. Chair in International Trade
Haas School of Business
UC Berkeley
ftrebbi@berkeley.edu

Professor Mitsuru Igami
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of Toronto
mitsuru.igami@utoronto.ca